

12 Client Email Scripts

Copy, personalize the [brackets], send. Each script includes a note on why it's worded the way it is. Keep your edits short — these work because they're brief and unapologetic.

1. Responding to a New Inquiry

Subject: Re: [Their subject]

Hi [Name],

Thanks for reaching out — [one specific sentence showing you read their message, e.g., “a rebrand ahead of your spring launch is exactly the kind of project I like”].

The best next step is a short call so I can understand what you're after and tell you honestly whether I'm the right fit. Here are two times that work: [option 1] or [option 2]. If neither works, here's my calendar: [link].

Talk soon, [You]

Why it works: responds fast, offers concrete times (reduces back-and-forth), and frames the call as diagnosis, not sales.

2. Post-Discovery-Call Recap

Subject: Recap + next steps

Hi [Name],

Great talking today. Quick recap so we're aligned:

- **Goal:** [their goal, their words]
- **Main challenge:** [their pain point]
- **Budget range discussed:** [range]
- **Next step:** I'll send a proposal by [day]; we review it together on [date/time].

If I got anything wrong, tell me now — the proposal will be built on exactly this.

[You]

Why it works: creates a written record, confirms budget in writing, and locks the review call.

3. Sending the Proposal

Subject: Proposal: [project name]

Hi [Name],

Attached is the proposal we discussed. Two things before you open it:

1. There are **two options** — the difference is [one-sentence distinction].
2. It's valid until **[date]**, because my schedule fills about [3] weeks out.

Looking forward to walking through it on [scheduled date]. Bring questions.

[You]

4. Nudging a Silent Proposal (send after 4–5 business days)

Subject: Re: Proposal: [project name]

Hi [Name],

Checking in on the proposal. Usually when I don't hear back it's one of three things:

1. You're busy and it's on the pile — no problem, it's valid until [date].
2. Something in it doesn't sit right — happy to adjust; tell me which part.
3. Plans changed — also fine; just let me know so I can release the start date I'm holding.

Which one is it?

[You]

Why it works: gives an easy multiple-choice reply instead of demanding a decision, and #3 makes silence costly.

5. Kickoff Confirmation (the day they say yes)

Subject: We're on — next steps

[Name], great decision. Here's what happens now:

1. **Today:** You'll receive the agreement to sign and the deposit invoice ([X]% of [total]).
2. **Once both are in:** I'll send a short kickoff questionnaire and calendar link for our kickoff call.
3. **[Start date]:** Work begins.

Any questions, reply here. Excited to get started.

[You]

6. Pushing Back on Scope Creep

Subject: Re: [their request]

Hi [Name],

Happy to do this — [restate their request in one line] sits outside our current scope ([reference: “the proposal includes X”]), so here’s how we can handle it:

- **Add it now:** [\$X], adds [Y days] to the timeline. I’ll send a one-line change order to approve.
- **Phase 2 it:** we finish the current scope on schedule and quote this after.

Which do you prefer?

[You]

Why it works: never says “no” — it says “yes, and here’s the price.” The friendly tone plus a firm boundary is the entire game.

7. Late Payment — First Notice (day after due date)

Subject: Invoice [#] — past due

Hi [Name],

Flagging that invoice [#] for [\$X] was due [yesterday]. Here’s the link again: [link].

If it’s already in process, ignore me. If something’s holding it up, let me know today so we can sort it.

Thanks, [You]

8. Late Payment — Second Notice (7 days overdue)

Subject: Invoice [#] — 7 days overdue, work paused

Hi [Name],

Invoice [#] is now 7 days past due. Per our agreement, I’ve paused work as of today, and late fees of [1.5%/month] apply from the due date.

As soon as payment lands, work resumes immediately and the schedule picks back up — day-for-day.

Payment link: [link]. If there’s a genuine issue, call me today: [number].

[You]

Why it works: calm, factual, contract-backed. Pausing work is your leverage — a freelancer who keeps working while unpaid teaches the client that invoices are optional.

9. Raising Rates with an Existing Client

Subject: Updated rates from [date, 6–8 weeks out]

Hi [Name],

A heads-up with plenty of notice: starting [date], my rate moves from [\$X] to [\$Y].

Working with you has been a highlight — that's exactly why I'm telling you [6–8] weeks early, and why anything we book before [date] stays at the current rate.

Happy to talk through what this means for [ongoing work].

[You]

Why it works: no justification paragraph, no apology. The early notice and grandfathering do the relationship work.

10. Client Gone Silent Mid-Project

Subject: [Project] on hold — need your input by [date]

Hi [Name],

I need [specific item] to keep [project] moving. I've asked on [dates], so the project is now effectively paused.

If I have it by [date], we stay roughly on schedule. After that, I'll need to move my calendar around and delivery shifts to [new window] — per our agreement, the timeline extends day-for-day.

What's the best way to get this unstuck?

[You]

11. Delivering Final Work

Subject: [Project] — final delivery 🎉

Hi [Name],

It's done — final files are here: [link].

- **What's included:** [list]
- **Final invoice:** attached, due [date]. Per our agreement, full ownership transfers on payment.
- **Support:** I'm on hand for [14 days] for questions and small fixes.

It's been a pleasure. Once you've had a week with it, I'll send one short favor to ask (two minutes, I promise).

[You]

12. Asking for a Testimonial + Referral (7–10 days after delivery)

Subject: That two-minute favor

Hi [Name],

That favor: would you write 2–3 sentences about the results of [project]? Useful angles: what changed [metric, speed, stress], and what surprised you about the process.

And if you know **one** person wrestling with [problem you solve], an intro would mean a lot — I have room for [one/two] new clients in [month].

Thanks again — this project was a good one.

[You]

Why it works: asked at peak satisfaction, sized as tiny (“2–3 sentences”, “one person”), and specific about what to write.

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